



Celebrating a Relationship Built on
Heritage, Strengthened by Trade,
and Inspired by Opportunity.



Confidential and Proprietary
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Foreword

The Chamber of Commerce and Industry of India (CCI INDIA) has, since its inception, worked to widen the horizon of Indian enterprise beyond its traditional and well-trodden trade partnerships. As global supply chains are redrawn amid geopolitical realignment, the search for new, resilient and mutually beneficial markets has become a strategic imperative for Indian industry. It is in this context that CCI INDIA presents this Knowledge Paper on India–Georgia economic cooperation.

Georgia, a small yet strategically located economy at the crossroads of Europe and Asia, has in recent years emerged as one of the fastest-growing and most reform-oriented economies in the wider Eurasian region. Its position astride the Middle Corridor the Trans-Caspian International Transport Route linking China and Central Asia with Europe via the Caspian Sea, the South Caucasus and the Black Sea gives it a connectivity value that far exceeds the size of its domestic market. For Indian businesses seeking diversified, de-risked and future-ready trade routes into Europe, Georgia's Free Trade Agreements with the European Union, China, and other major markets present an underutilised gateway.

India and Georgia share a long and cordial diplomatic relationship, dating to India's early recognition of Georgian independence in December 1991. Yet the economic relationship between the two nations remains modest relative to its potential, with bilateral trade still measured in tens of millions of dollars rather than the hundreds of millions that the complementarities between the two economies would justify. This gap between diplomatic goodwill and commercial engagement represents precisely the space in which institutions such as CCI INDIA can add the greatest value.

CCI INDIA remains committed to strengthening India's economic diplomacy at the institutional level, and to ensuring that the opportunities identified in this report translate into concrete commercial outcomes for Indian industry, particularly micro, small and medium enterprises (MSMEs) for whom the Middle Corridor and the Georgian market offer a genuine, if underexplored, frontier.

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read "Munindra Kumar".

Munindra Kumar
Director General
CCI India

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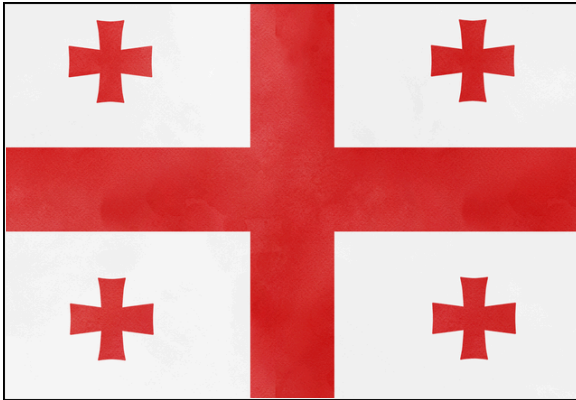
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GEORGIA

“ Short distances, coastal towns, and scenic Mediterranean views make budget travel easy while allowing you to immerse yourself in local culture.



Basic Facts and Demographics

Georgia is a strategically located country in the Caucasus region, positioned at the crossroads of Eastern Europe and Western Asia. It has a population of approximately 3.9 million people, with Tbilisi as its capital and largest city. The official currency is the Georgian Lari (GEL).

Economic Landscape and Gross Domestic Product (GDP)

Georgia's GDP is approximately USD 38 billion, reflecting strong growth driven by tourism, logistics, trade, financial services, and infrastructure development. The country has implemented significant economic reforms to attract foreign direct investment and promote private sector development. Key areas of growth include infrastructure, energy, and logistics. Despite its relatively small economic size, Georgia has successfully integrated into regional and global markets. **The primary sectors contributing to GDP are:**

Agriculture: Agriculture plays an important role in rural employment, with key products including grapes (for wine production), fruits, vegetables, and livestock. Georgian wine is internationally recognized and contributes to export earnings.

Services: The service sector is the largest contributor to GDP, with tourism being a major driver. Georgia attracts international visitors due to its natural landscapes, cultural heritage, and affordable travel. Banking, trade, and hospitality services are also growing rapidly.

Industry: The industrial sector includes light manufacturing, mining, and energy production. Hydropower and natural resources support industrial activity, while construction contributes to infrastructure development.



“Culture and Heritage

Georgia's heritage reaches back to ancient times, carrying stories that have shaped its people for thousands of years. It is often celebrated as one of the earliest regions to make wine, a practice still honored with pride. Historic buildings, lively music and dance, and flavorful dishes help define its character. With roots connected to both European and Asian traditions, Georgia offers a cultural blend that is rich, warm, and unforgettable.

Bilateral Trade With India — Value & Composition

India–Georgia trade has shown steady growth, supported by increasing connectivity and business interest.

- Total Trade (2024–25 est.): ~USD 250–350 million
- India's exports to Georgia: pharmaceuticals, machinery, textiles, chemicals
- India's imports from Georgia: metals, fertilizers, agricultural products

India is also a significant contributor to education services, with many Indian students studying medicine in Georgia.

Economic & Strategic Areas Of Cooperation

Key areas of cooperation between India and Georgia include:

- Pharmaceutical exports and healthcare services
- Education (medical and technical studies)
- Tourism and hospitality sector growth
- Logistics and transport corridors
- IT and digital services

Georgia's role as a gateway to Europe and Central Asia enhances its attractiveness for Indian businesses.



Cultural & People-To-People Links

Cultural ties between India and Georgia are growing:

- Increasing number of Indian students in Georgian universities
- Rising tourism exchanges
- Interest in Indian culture, cinema, and cuisine

These connections are strengthening long-term engagement beyond trade.

Conclusion & Recommendations

Georgia is a dynamic, reform-driven economy with strategic importance as a transit hub between Europe and Asia.

Key Takeaways:

1. Georgia offers strong growth and a business-friendly environment
2. It serves as a gateway to wider regional markets
3. India–Georgia ties are expanding in trade, education, and tourism
4. Market size is small but strategically valuable



Chapter 1 Introduction and Strategic Context

1.1 Purpose of the Report

This Knowledge Paper has been prepared by CCI INDIA to provide a comprehensive, evidence-based assessment of the opportunities and constraints shaping India's economic engagement with Georgia, and to articulate a concrete institutional role for CCI INDIA in deepening that engagement. The report is intended for policymakers within the Government of India, Indian diplomatic missions, industry leaders, exporters, investors, and institutional partners considering the South Caucasus as a frontier market. It is structured to move from macroeconomic and sectoral analysis, through an assessment of existing diplomatic and institutional linkages, to a set of implementation-ready policy recommendations and a phased strategic roadmap.

The analysis draws on the latest available data (2024–2026) from the World Bank, the International Monetary Fund (IMF), the Asian Development Bank (ADB), the European Bank for Reconstruction and Development (EBRD), Geostat (Georgia's National Statistics Office), the National Bank of Georgia, UN Comtrade, the International Trade Centre's Trade Map, and the Government of India's Ministry of Commerce and Industry, among other authoritative sources, in order to ensure that the recommendations offered are grounded in current economic realities rather than static assumptions about a fast-changing region.

1.2 Georgia's Geopolitical Importance

Georgia occupies a compact but consequential position in the South Caucasus, bordered by Russia to the north, Azerbaijan to the east, Armenia and Türkiye to the south, and the Black Sea to the west. This location places Georgia at the intersection of several of the twenty-first century's most consequential geo-economic developments: the reconfiguration of Eurasian trade routes following the Russia-Ukraine conflict, the European Union's search for diversified energy and connectivity partnerships in Central Asia, and the broader contest over transit infrastructure linking China, Central Asia, and Europe.

Since 2022, sanctions on Russia and the resulting decline in the use of the Northern Corridor (the traditional China–Russia–Europe rail route) have accelerated interest in alternative Eurasian transit routes, most notably the Middle Corridor. Georgia, along with Azerbaijan and Kazakhstan, has emerged as a core participant in this route, and has attracted growing attention and investment from the European Union, the World Bank, the EBRD, the Asian Development Bank, and the United States as a result.

1.3 Georgia as a Europe–Asia Gateway: The Middle Corridor

The Middle Corridor, formally known as the Trans-Caspian International Transport Route (TITR), is a multimodal trade route connecting Western China and Central Asia to Europe via Kazakhstan, the Caspian Sea, Azerbaijan, Georgia and Türkiye. It represents the shortest overland route between China and Europe, bypassing both the Russia-dependent Northern Corridor and the Suez Canal-dependent Ocean Route. The corridor's cargo volumes have grown rapidly since 2022, and the Trans-Caspian Transport Corridor Coordination Platform, established in 2024 by the participating states, is working to harmonise customs procedures and reduce cross-border delays.

For India, the Middle Corridor is best understood not as a rival to the International North–South Transport Corridor (INSTC) which links Indian ports to Europe via Iran, the Caspian Sea and Russia but as a complementary second leg of Eurasian connectivity. Indian policy analysts have increasingly noted that INSTC's western route, once fully operational, intersects the Middle Corridor in Azerbaijan, from where Baku–Tbilisi–Batumi and Baku–Tbilisi–Kars rail links offer India a further route into the Black Sea region and onward into Europe. Given recent disruptions to India's Chabahar-based connectivity strategy amid renewed sanctions pressure, diversifying overland and multimodal options through Georgia carries added strategic value for India's long-term trade resilience.

Georgia's Black Sea ports principally Poti and Batumi, alongside the planned deep-water port at Anaklia together with the Baku–Tbilisi–Kars railway and the East–West Highway, constitute the physical backbone of this connectivity. Continued investment by international financial institutions, including the World Bank, EBRD, and ADB, in port capacity, rail electrification, and logistics hubs along this corridor is expected to reduce transit times and costs over the coming decade, enhancing the corridor's attractiveness for Indian cargo bound for Europe, the Black Sea littoral, and the wider CIS market.

Potential Role of CCI INDIA

CCI INDIA can position itself as India's principal institutional interlocutor on Middle Corridor connectivity, working with Invest India, the Ministry of Commerce and Industry, and Indian logistics operators to assess the commercial viability of routing Indian cargo through Georgia, and to represent Indian industry's interests in Middle Corridor coordination forums alongside Georgian, Azerbaijani, Kazakh and European counterparts.

1.4 Importance for Indian Businesses

Three structural features of the Georgian economy make it relevant to Indian business strategy. First, Georgia maintains one of the most liberal trade and investment regimes in the region, underpinned by a network of Free Trade Agreements with the European Union, China, the CIS states, Türkiye, the United Kingdom, and the United Arab Emirates, together with membership of the World Trade Organization. Indian firms manufacturing or assembling in Georgia can, in principle, access these markets on preferential terms not available directly from India. Second, Georgia's regulatory environment for starting and operating a business remains comparatively straightforward relative to regional peers, reflecting a sustained reform effort over the past two decades. Third, growing sectors such as information technology, tourism, renewable energy, and agro-processing align closely with areas of established Indian competitive strength, including IT-enabled services, generic pharmaceuticals, renewable energy engineering, and food processing.

At the same time, the relationship remains constrained by low mutual awareness: Indian exporters frequently lack visibility into Georgian regulatory requirements, certification standards, and distribution channels, while Georgian enterprises have limited familiarity with the scale and terms on which they might access the Indian market. This information gap is precisely the kind of market failure that a dedicated business chamber is positioned to address.

1.5 Scope and Objectives of the Report

- Present an updated, data-driven overview of Georgia's macroeconomic position, key industries, trade agreements, and logistics infrastructure (Chapter 2).
- Assess the current state of India–Georgia diplomatic, trade, investment, and institutional relations (Chapter 3).
- Define CCI INDIA's distinctive institutional role, services, sectoral alignment, and government linkages relevant to Georgia (Chapter 4).
- Provide sector-wise and sub-vertical trade analysis identifying near-term commercial opportunities (Chapters 5 and 6).
- Set out implementation-ready policy recommendations and financial mechanisms available to support bilateral cooperation (Chapter 7).
- Propose a phased strategic roadmap spanning the short, medium and long term (Chapter 8).

1.6 Why CCI INDIA is Preparing this Report

CCI INDIA's institutional mandate encompasses trade facilitation, policy advocacy, and international cooperation on behalf of Indian industry, with a particular emphasis on identifying and cultivating emerging markets that are not yet the primary focus of India's larger and more established chambers of commerce. Georgia and the wider Middle Corridor region represents precisely such a frontier: a market too small in absolute terms to command sustained attention from the largest Indian conglomerates, but strategically significant enough, and sufficiently aligned with Indian sectoral strengths, to reward focused institutional engagement. By preparing this report, CCI INDIA seeks to establish itself as the leading Indian institutional voice on India–Georgia and India–South Caucasus economic cooperation.

Implications for CCI INDIA

This report itself constitutes a first concrete step in CCI INDIA's Georgia strategy: it establishes the evidentiary and analytical basis on which CCI INDIA can approach the Ministry of Commerce and Industry, Invest India, the Embassy of India, and Georgian institutional counterparts (Enterprise Georgia, the Ministry of Economy and Sustainable Development, and the Georgian Chamber of Commerce and Industry) to propose a structured programme of bilateral engagement, beginning with the establishment of an India–Georgia Business Council.

Chapter 2 Georgia's Economic Overview

2.1 Macroeconomic Snapshot

Georgia has recorded one of the strongest growth performances in Europe and Central Asia over the past three years. Real GDP grew by 9.4 percent in 2024 and an estimated 7.5 percent in 2025, with growth in the first two months of 2026 running at 8.4 percent year-on-year before moderating amid rising regional geopolitical risk. Nominal GDP reached approximately USD 38.1 billion (GEL 104.6 billion) in 2025. Multilateral forecasters the World Bank, IMF, ADB and EBRD converge on a 2026 growth projection in the range of 5.0 to 6.5 percent, with the wide range reflecting uncertainty over the regional impact of the conflict in the Middle East on tourism, energy costs and transit trade. Growth in 2025 was driven primarily by private consumption (up 8.2 percent), underpinned by real wage growth of 11.5 percent and strong credit expansion, alongside robust performance in the ICT, education, transport and trade sectors.

Inflation has been volatile but broadly contained: after averaging just 1.1 percent in 2023–2024, consumer price inflation accelerated to around 4.6–5.9 percent in early 2026 amid higher food, fuel and electricity prices linked to regional instability, prompting the National Bank of Georgia to raise its refinancing rate to 8.25 percent. Georgia's external position has strengthened, with the current account deficit narrowing to 2.6 percent of GDP in 2025 from 4.6 percent in 2024, supported by strong services exports (including ICT and tourism) and remittance inflows. Public debt stood at approximately 34 percent of GDP at end-2025, among the lowest in the region, while the fiscal deficit was contained at 1.7–2.5 percent of GDP. Foreign exchange reserves rose sharply, reaching 3.9 months of import cover by early 2026, and Georgia successfully placed a USD 500 million Eurobond in January 2026, reflecting continued investor confidence in the sovereign credit story despite regional headwinds.

Table 2.1: Georgia Key Macroeconomic Indicators

Indicator	2024	2025	2026 (Projected)
Real GDP growth (%)	9.4%	7.5%	5.0% – 6.5%
Nominal GDP (USD bn)	~34.0	~38.1	~40 – 42
Inflation, average (%)	1.1%	4.0% 4.6%	– 4.5% – 4.9%
Current account deficit (% GDP)	4.6%	2.6%	~3.0%
Public debt (% GDP)	~35%	~34%	~34% – 35%
Fiscal deficit (% GDP)	~3.0%	1.7%	2.5% target) (budget

Indicator	2024	2025	2026 (Projected)
Tourism revenue (USD bn)	~4.4	~4.6	~4.9 (forecast)
Net FDI inflows (% GDP)	n/a	3.6%	n/a

For Indian businesses, three implications follow from this macroeconomic profile. First, Georgia's rapid, broad-based growth signals a rising middle class and expanding domestic demand for imported consumer goods, pharmaceuticals, and machinery a demand pool that Indian exporters have so far barely tapped. Second, low public debt, contained fiscal deficits, and a stable currency regime reduce sovereign and macroeconomic risk for Indian investors relative to many other emerging markets. Third, Georgia's growing dependence on services exports (ICT and tourism) rather than goods exports suggests that Indian services firms particularly in IT, business process outsourcing, and healthcare may find as much opportunity in Georgia as goods exporters.

Potential Role of CCI INDIA

CCI INDIA can commission an annual 'Georgia Market Monitor' briefing note for Indian industry, translating headline macroeconomic and sectoral data into actionable trade and investment signals, distributed to member companies and Export Promotion Councils.

2.2 Key Industries and Investment Climate

Tourism

Tourism is now one of the largest single sources of foreign exchange for Georgia, with revenues reaching approximately USD 4.6 billion in 2025 (up 4.9 percent year-on-year) and projected to reach USD 4.9 billion in 2026. Wine tourism, in particular, has become a signature growth niche, with the Kakheti wine region increasingly marketed internationally alongside Georgia's Black Sea coastline and mountain destinations. For India, this presents two distinct opportunities: growing two-way tourist flows (Georgia has emerged as a popular, visa-friendly destination for Indian leisure travellers and wedding parties), and potential Indian investment in hospitality infrastructure, given continued growth in visitor arrivals from the Gulf, East Asia and Europe.

Information and Communication Technology (ICT)

Georgia's ICT sector has expanded rapidly, now accounting for approximately 8.2 percent of nominal GDP and ranking as the fourth-largest sector in the economy. ICT service exports totalled USD 842 million in 2024 and rose 52.3 percent year-on-year to USD 898 million in the third quarter of 2025 alone, now representing some 14 percent of total service exports. Georgia's 'Virtual Zone' regime offering 0 percent corporate tax on foreign-sourced IT service income combined with low operating costs and a growing pool of technically skilled talent, makes the country an increasingly credible, if still small-scale, near-shoring and back-office destination. Indian IT and IT-enabled services firms, already global leaders in outsourced software development and business process management, could explore Georgia both as an export market for enterprise software and cybersecurity solutions and as a platform for regional service delivery into the EU and CIS markets.

Agriculture and Food Processing

Agriculture remains a significant, if not dominant, contributor to Georgian GDP, with wine, hazelnuts, mineral water, and citrus as flagship export products. Georgian wine exports reached approximately 89.7 million litres to 71 countries in 2025, at an average export price of USD 2.98 per litre, with premium markets such as the United States (USD 6.20/litre), Japan (USD 5.82/litre) and the United Kingdom (USD 5.10/litre) commanding significantly higher prices than traditional CIS markets. Georgia is among the world's top five hazelnut producers, with the EU (Italy, Spain, Germany, France, Greece) as the principal export destination. Agricultural exports overall rose 15 percent year-on-year in the first quarter of 2026, aided by a Georgian government diversification drive that has lifted the combined share of the EU, Middle East and East Asian markets in Georgian agri-exports to over 45 percent.

Manufacturing, Mining and Logistics

Mining remains Georgia's largest single export category by value, led by copper ore, ferro-alloys and manganese, historically anchored around the Chiatura manganese deposits. Manufacturing is comparatively modest in scale but growing in niches such as construction materials, machinery assembly and, more recently, steel processing illustrated by past Indian corporate engagement, including JSW Steel's joint venture with Georgian Steel Group Holding to convert scrap metal into reinforced steel bars. Logistics and transport services have grown in tandem with Middle Corridor cargo volumes and are treated in greater depth in Section 2.4 below.

Financial Services and Investment Climate

Georgia's banking sector remains sound, with non-performing loans at 2.5 percent, return on equity around 22 percent, and return on assets approaching 3.9 percent as of early 2026. The World Bank has consistently ranked Georgia among the region's strongest reformers on ease of doing business indicators, reflecting simplified company registration, a low and predictable tax regime, and limited restrictions on foreign ownership or capital repatriation. Net FDI inflows, however, remained comparatively subdued at 3.6 percent of GDP in 2025, reflecting cautious investor sentiment amid domestic political tension and the country's paused EU accession process a reminder that macroeconomic strength alone does not guarantee investment flows, and that targeted sector- and country-specific promotion (of the kind CCI INDIA can provide for the Indian market) remains valuable.

Table 2.2: Priority Georgian Industries and Indicative Trade Relevance for India

Sector	2025 Scale / Performance	Relevance to India
Tourism & Hospitality	USD 4.6 bn revenue (+4.9% y/y)	Two-way tourism; hospitality investment
ICT & Digital Services	USD 898 mn exports in 3Q25 (+52.3% y/y)	IT/ITeS exports; cybersecurity; near-shoring
Agriculture & Food Processing	Agri-exports +15% y/y in Q1 2026	Wine/hazelnut imports; food-processing JV
Mining & Metals	Largest goods export category	Raw material sourcing; steel JV (e.g., JSW precedent)
Renewable Energy	Hydropower-dominant generation mix	Equipment exports; EPC & investment
Logistics & Transport	Rising Middle Corridor cargo volumes	Transit route diversification for Indian trade
Financial Services	NPLs 2.5%; ROE ~22%	Correspondent banking; fintech partnerships

Potential Role of CCI INDIA

CCI INDIA can convene sector-specific working groups beginning with agri-processing, ICT, and renewable energy to match Indian exporters and investors with Georgian counterparts identified through Enterprise Georgia and the Georgian Chamber of Commerce and Industry, and can support Indian MSMEs in navigating Georgia's certification and phytosanitary requirements for food and agricultural exports.

2.3 Trade Agreements and Market Access

Georgia's most distinctive economic asset, from an Indian strategic perspective, is not the size of its own market but the breadth of preferential market access that a Georgian production or trading base confers. Georgia maintains free trade agreements with the European Union (via the Deep and Comprehensive Free Trade Area, in force since 2016), China (signed 2017, in force 2018), Hong Kong (signed 2018, in force 2019), the European Free Trade Association Iceland, Liechtenstein, Norway and Switzerland (in force since 2017), Türkiye, the United Kingdom, the United Arab Emirates, and all CIS member states except Russia and Uzbekistan. Collectively, these agreements give Georgian-origin goods preferential access to markets representing approximately 2.2 billion people and around 40 percent of global GDP a free-trade footprint disproportionate to Georgia's own economic size.

For Indian companies, this creates a theoretical, though currently underutilised, opportunity: goods manufactured, assembled, or sufficiently transformed in Georgia to satisfy rules-of-origin requirements can access the EU, China, and other FTA partner markets on preferential or duty-free terms not available to goods exported directly from India. In practice, realising this benefit requires Indian firms to establish a Georgian corporate presence, comply with Georgian rules-of-origin documentation (including Certificates of Origin), and structure supply chains accordingly precisely the kind of technical, procedural guidance that a trade-facilitation body such as CCI INDIA, working alongside its Certificate of Origin issuance services, is positioned to provide.

It is notable that Georgia and India themselves conducted a joint feasibility study for a bilateral Free Trade Agreement, completed in January 2019, though this has not yet progressed to formal negotiations. Reviving this process or, at minimum, exploring an interim Preferential Trade Agreement or Trade and Economic Cooperation framework would materially strengthen the direct trade relationship and is addressed further as a recommendation in Chapter 7.

Separately, EU–Georgia trade relations have cooled somewhat following the Georgian government's December 2024 decision to pause EU accession negotiations, with the European Union subsequently suspending certain budgetary and bilateral cooperation programmes. While the DCFTA itself remains legally in force, the broader political chill counsels a degree of caution: Indian firms considering Georgia primarily as an EU market-access platform should monitor the evolving EU-Georgia political relationship, even as Georgia's FTAs with China, the UK, EFTA and the Gulf remain unaffected and continue to offer robust market-access value.

Table 2.3: Georgia's Free Trade Agreement Network

Partner / Bloc	Status	Approx. Population Covered
European Union (DCFTA)	In force since 2016	~450 million
China	In force since 2018	~1.4 billion
Hong Kong, China	In force since 2019	~7.5 million
EFTA (Iceland, Liechtenstein, Norway, Switzerland)	In force since 2017	~14 million
Türkiye	In force (since 2008)	~85 million
United Kingdom	In force (post-Brexit continuity)	~68 million
United Arab Emirates (CEPA)	In force	~10 million
CIS States (excl. Russia, Uzbekistan)	In force	~180 million
India	Joint feasibility study completed 2019; not yet negotiated	~1.45 billion (potential)

Potential Role of CCI INDIA

CCI INDIA can formally petition the Ministry of Commerce and Industry and DGFT to revive the dormant India–Georgia FTA feasibility track, and in the interim, can publish a practical guide for Indian exporters on structuring Georgia-based operations to access DCFTA and China-FTA preferences, supported by CCI INDIA's own Certificate of Origin facilitation services.

2.4 Logistics and Connectivity

Georgia's transport infrastructure is undergoing its most significant transformation since independence, driven by its position on the Middle Corridor. The Baku–Tbilisi–Kars railway, operational since 2017, links Georgia directly to Türkiye and, via Azerbaijan, to the Trans-Caspian rail network reaching into Central Asia and China. The East–West Highway, still under phased construction and upgrade, is intended to provide a modern four-lane road connection between Georgia's Black Sea coast and its eastern border with Azerbaijan, reducing transit times for road freight along the corridor.

Georgia's two established Black Sea ports, Poti and Batumi, currently handle the bulk of the country's maritime trade, but both are reaching operational and draft-depth limits for larger vessels. This has driven the long-running effort to construct a new deep-water port at Anaklia, capable of accommodating vessels that cannot currently call at Georgian ports. The Anaklia project has had a troubled history: an initial private consortium's contract was terminated in 2020, a China Communications Construction Company-led consortium was named preferred developer in May 2024 but has not signed a binding investment agreement, and 2026 budget allocations for the project were cut by roughly two-thirds amid fiscal caution. In May 2026, the Georgian government announced it would pursue a state-led 'landlord' model, retaining ownership of core maritime infrastructure while leasing operational capacity to private and international tenants, and construction of the breakwater and dredging works (contracted to the Belgian firm Jan De Nul) resumed, with completion targeted for late 2026 or early 2027 and first vessel calls anticipated around 2029.

Beyond ports and rail, Georgia is also developing its role in regional energy connectivity, including a proposed Black Sea submarine electricity cable intended to link Georgia (and, indirectly, Azerbaijani and Central Asian renewable generation) to the European electricity grid via Romania a project that, if realised, would reinforce Georgia's positioning as an energy as well as a trade transit hub. Kutaisi International Airport, meanwhile, has emerged as a growing secondary aviation gateway alongside Tbilisi, supporting the tourism sector's continued expansion.

Table 2.4: Key Georgian Connectivity Infrastructure

Asset	Function	Status (mid-2026)
Anaklia Deep-Sea Port	New Black Sea container/bulk port; ~600,000 TEU capacity	Under construction; state-led landlord model; completion ~2026-27
Port of Poti	Existing Black Sea container port	Operating at capacity; private northward expansion underway
Port of Batumi	Existing Black Sea multipurpose port	Operational; capacity-constrained
Baku–Tbilisi–Kars Railway	Rail link to Azerbaijan/Türkiye/Central Asia	Operational since 2017
East–West Highway	Primary road corridor, Black Sea to Azerbaijan border	Phased upgrade ongoing
Black Sea Electricity Cable	Subsea power link, Georgia–Romania (EU grid)	Planning / early development

Asset		Function	Status (mid-2026)
Kutaisi Airport	International	Secondary aviation gateway	Operational; expanding tourism traffic

Potential Role of CCI INDIA

CCI INDIA should track the Anaklia port's construction milestones closely, as the port's eventual operational status will materially affect the commercial viability of routing Indian cargo through Georgia; in the interim, CCI INDIA can facilitate exploratory contact between Indian logistics operators and the established Poti and Batumi port operators, and support Indian participation in Middle Corridor investment and coordination forums such as the Trans-Caspian Transport Corridor Coordination Platform.

Chapter 3 India–Georgia Diplomatic Relations and Business Context

3.1 Evolution of Diplomatic Relations

India was among the first countries to recognise Georgian independence, doing so on 26 December 1991, with formal diplomatic relations established on 28 September 1992. For more than three decades thereafter, the relationship was managed at arm's length: India's ambassador to Armenia, resident in Yerevan, held concurrent accreditation to Georgia, while Georgia progressively upgraded its own presence in New Delhi from an honorary consulate opened in 2005 to a full embassy in 2010, with a resident Georgian ambassador in place since February 2010.

This asymmetry ended in March 2026, when Ambassador Amit Kumar Mishra assumed charge as India's first resident Ambassador to Georgia, presenting his credentials in Tbilisi on 27 March 2026. The establishment of a resident Indian mission in Tbilisi rather than continued management from Yerevan represents the single most significant institutional development in the bilateral relationship in over a decade, and reflects a broader recalibration of India's diplomatic footprint across the Caucasus and wider Eurasia. It follows the 8th round of India–Georgia Foreign Office Consultations, held in Tbilisi in December 2025 and co-chaired by India's Secretary (West) and Georgia's Deputy Foreign Minister, continuing a structured dialogue mechanism that began with the 7th round in New Delhi in November 2023. Georgia's Foreign Minister, Maka Bochorishvili, visited India in March 2025 to participate in the Raisina Dialogue, India's flagship geopolitical conference, and met with India's External Affairs Minister to discuss deepening political and economic ties.

An Inter-Governmental Commission (IGC) mechanism, co-chaired at the ministerial level, has met three times since its inception, with the 3rd session held in New Delhi in September 2017; regular convening of this commission going forward would provide an important institutional anchor for the kind of sector-specific cooperation (trade, investment, connectivity) discussed throughout this report. The historical relationship also carries a distinctive cultural dimension: the twelfth-century Georgian national epic, 'The Knight in the Panther's Skin' by Shota Rustaveli, features an Indian prince among its central characters, and India's Panchatantra fables are believed to have influenced Georgian folklore a shared civilisational thread that Indian and Georgian officials frequently invoke in bilateral statements.

Table 3.1: Milestones in India–Georgia Diplomatic Relations

Year	Milestone
1991	India recognises Georgian independence (26 December)
1992	Diplomatic relations formally established (28 September)
2005 / 2010	Georgia opens honorary consulate (2005), upgraded to embassy with resident ambassador (2010) in New Delhi
2017	3rd India–Georgia Inter-Governmental Commission held in New Delhi
2023	7th round of Foreign Office Consultations held in New Delhi (November)
2025	Georgian Foreign Minister visits India for the Raisina Dialogue (March); 8th round of Foreign Office Consultations held in Tbilisi (December)
2026	India's first resident Ambassador to Georgia, Amit Kumar Mishra, presents credentials in Tbilisi (March)

Potential Role of CCI INDIA

CCI INDIA should formally welcome the establishment of the resident Indian Embassy in Tbilisi and proactively engage Ambassador Mishra's mission as an institutional partner, proposing that the Embassy co-host CCI INDIA's proposed India–Georgia Business Council launch event and support its outreach to Georgian government counterparts.

3.2 Bilateral Trade

Bilateral merchandise trade between India and Georgia, while growing, remains modest in absolute terms. India's exports to Georgia were valued at approximately USD 242 million in 2024, led by pharmaceutical products, machinery and mechanical appliances, cereals, electrical equipment, and optical and medical instruments. Georgian exports to India remain considerably smaller historically dominated by fertilisers (particularly ammonium nitrate), ferro-alloys, aluminium and copper articles but have shown striking recent growth off a low base: in January–February 2025, Georgian exports to India rose almost five-fold year-on-year to USD 4.3 million, while two-way trade turnover for the same period nearly doubled to USD 21 million.

This trade relationship remains heavily asymmetric (India's exports to Georgia running roughly five to ten times Georgia's exports to India) and concentrated in a narrow range of product categories on both sides. This pattern is consistent with a relationship that has not yet been the subject of sustained institutional trade promotion effort by either side, and stands in contrast to the far larger trade volumes India maintains with comparably sized economies elsewhere in Europe and Central Asia. The gap represents the central commercial opportunity this report seeks to address: even a doubling or tripling of current bilateral trade volumes a realistic near-term ambition given the low base would represent a meaningful, low-risk expansion of India's export markets.

Table 3.2: India–Georgia Merchandise Trade Snapshot

Indicator	Value	Period
India's exports to Georgia	~USD 242 million	2024 (annual)
India's imports from Georgia	~USD 31 million	2023 (annual)
Georgia's exports to India (growth)	~5x year-on-year increase	Jan–Feb 2025
Two-way trade turnover	~USD 21 million	Jan–Feb 2025
Top Indian exports to Georgia	Pharmaceuticals; machinery; cereals; electrical equipment	2025
Top Georgian exports to India	Fertilisers (ammonium nitrate); tobacco; ferro-alloys	2025

Potential Role of CCI INDIA

CCI INDIA can establish a bilateral Trade Information Desk, in coordination with DGFT and the Indian Embassy in Tbilisi, to track and publish quarterly bilateral trade data, identify emerging product opportunities (as Georgian export diversification creates new demand for Indian machinery, chemicals, and consumer goods), and support Indian MSME exporters in navigating Georgian customs and certification requirements.

3.3 Investment Cooperation

Formal investment flows between India and Georgia remain limited but include some notable precedents. JSW Steel's Dutch subsidiary partnered with Georgian Steel Group Holding to establish a plant converting metal scrap into reinforced steel bars, and Indian ambassadorial visits have continued to engage with Indian-linked manufacturing operations such as the Geosteel Ltd plant in Rustavi. Beyond corporate investment, a distinctive and under-recognised feature of the relationship is a base of roughly 150 individual Indian investors predominantly from Punjab who have acquired agricultural land in Georgia for cultivation, reflecting Georgia's comparatively liberal land-ownership rules for foreign nationals and its suitability for certain forms of agriculture.

India's Ministry of External Affairs and Georgia's Ministry of Economy and Sustainable Development have discussed cooperation on energy infrastructure, including reported Indian interest in transmission-line construction (overhead transmission lines) as part of Georgia's expanding power grid. However, in aggregate, formal bilateral investment remains far below potential, reflecting both the absence (to date) of a Bilateral Investment Treaty or Double Taxation Avoidance Agreement between the two countries, and limited awareness among Indian institutional investors of Georgia's liberal investment climate, discussed in Chapter 2.

Potential Role of CCI INDIA

CCI INDIA can compile and publicise a directory of existing Indian investment footholds in Georgia corporate and individual to serve as reference case studies and referral points for prospective Indian investors, and can jointly advocate, with Invest India, for the negotiation of a Bilateral Investment Treaty and Double Taxation Avoidance Agreement as foundational instruments to de-risk larger-scale Indian investment.

3.4 Tourism and Education

Education has emerged as the single largest and most dynamic dimension of the India–Georgia relationship, driven almost entirely by the enrolment of Indian students overwhelmingly in medicine at Georgian universities. Estimates of the current Indian student population in Georgia vary by source, ranging from approximately 10,000 (per Reserve Bank of India-linked remittance data) to over 20,000 (per education-consultancy estimates), the great majority pursuing MBBS-equivalent medical degrees at institutions such as Tbilisi State Medical University, David Tvildiani Medical University, Batumi Shota Rustaveli State University, and a growing roster of private universities recognised by India's National Medical Commission (NMC) and the World Health Organization.

The appeal rests on a combination of substantially lower fees than Indian private medical colleges (approximately INR 15–40 lakh for a complete six-year programme, against INR 60 lakh to over INR 1.5 crore in India), English-medium instruction, WHO/NMC recognition enabling graduates to sit India's FMGE/NEt licensing examination, and a comparatively short and direct flight connection between India and Tbilisi.

This large resident Indian community one of the largest Indian diaspora clusters in the wider Caucasus and Black Sea region constitutes both a significant existing people-to-people bridge and an underexploited commercial asset: it sustains demand for Indian food products, remittance and financial services, travel services, and cultural and religious institutions (reflected in the Embassy's engagement with Indian community festivals such as Hanuman Jayanti and Vaisakhi in various Georgian cities), and represents a pool of Georgia-experienced, English-and-Georgian-speaking young Indians who could support future trade and investment facilitation work.

Two-way tourism is a smaller but growing dimension of the relationship. Georgia has become an increasingly popular, visa-friendly leisure and wedding-destination for Indian travellers, benefiting from growing direct and one-stop air connectivity, while the Indian Tourism Seminar 'Incredible India', first held in Tbilisi in 2014, has periodically sought to build reciprocal interest among Georgian tour operators in India as a destination. Georgia's overall tourism sector, discussed in Chapter 2, generated approximately USD 4.6 billion in revenue in 2025, with Asian markets (including India) representing a small but growing share of the estimated 6-7 million annual international arrivals.

Potential Role of CCI INDIA

CCI INDIA can partner with the Indian Embassy in Tbilisi and Georgian tourism authorities to organise structured 'Buyer–Seller Meets' between Indian and Georgian tour operators, and can explore, together with Indian remittance and financial-services companies, dedicated banking and payment solutions tailored to Georgia's resident Indian student community, alongside outreach to Indian medical education consultancies to formalise information-sharing on university accreditation status.

3.5 Institutional Cooperation

Existing institutional cooperation mechanisms between India and Georgia include the Foreign Office Consultations (eight rounds held to date, most recently in Tbilisi in December 2025) and the Inter-Governmental Commission (three sessions held to date, most recently in New Delhi in 2017). Sector-specific cooperation has included a 2014 MoU on election management cooperation between the two countries' election commissions, and educational and cultural exchange facilitated through the Kendriya Hindi Sansthan's scholarships for Georgian students to study Hindi in India, and training programmes for Georgian diplomats conducted by India's Sushma Swaraj Institute of Foreign Service (SSIFS), through which 23 Georgian diplomats have received training to date.

The Gandhi Foundation Georgia, established in Tbilisi in June 2014 with support from India's Mahatma Gandhi Foundation, maintains an active branch presence in both Tbilisi and Batumi, and Georgia participates regularly in India's annual Surajkund Crafts Mela.

What is conspicuously absent from this institutional landscape, however, is any dedicated bilateral business or trade-promotion body analogous to the joint business councils India maintains with many of its other trading partners. Neither CII, FICCI, nor ASSOCHAM currently maintains a standing India–Georgia business council or working group, and no equivalent structure exists on the Georgian side connecting the Georgian Chamber of Commerce and Industry systematically with Indian counterparts. This institutional gap a genuine diplomatic relationship and a rapidly growing people-to-people bridge (principally through education), but no dedicated business-to-business institutional architecture is precisely the space CCI INDIA is positioned to fill, and is addressed in detail in Chapter 4.

Implications for CCI INDIA

Chapter 3 establishes that the political and people-to-people foundations for a much deeper India–Georgia economic relationship already exist a resident ambassador now in place, structured government-to-government dialogue mechanisms, and tens of thousands of Indian nationals resident in Georgia but that no institutional bridge currently translates this foundation into commercial outcomes. CCI INDIA's proposed India–Georgia Business Council would be the first body of its kind, and should be launched in coordination with the newly resident Indian Embassy in Tbilisi to maximise institutional credibility and government buy-in from the outset.

Chapter 4 Chamber of Commerce and Industry of India (CCI INDIA)

This chapter departs from a conventional organisational profile. Rather than simply describing CCI INDIA's history and structure, it analyses the institution along four dimensions directly relevant to the India–Georgia opportunity: its institutional mandate and positioning relative to India's other apex chambers; the concrete services it offers that map onto the needs identified in earlier chapters; the specific sectors in which its mandate aligns with Georgian opportunity; and its existing linkages with the Government of India bodies whose instruments will be required to operationalise the recommendations in Chapter 7.

4.1 Institutional Role

CCI INDIA (the Chamber of Commerce and Industry of India) positions itself as a representative organ of corporate India, articulating the interests of its members from the Indian private and public corporate sectors and multinational companies, and drawing its institutional strength from a network of affiliated regional chambers of commerce and industry across Indian states. Its stated mission centres on impacting the policy and legislative environment so as to foster balanced economic development, and on serving as a proactive, forward-looking institution a self-described evolution from an earlier, more reactive model of grievance representation towards a model of active policy engagement, business matchmaking, and cross-border facilitation.

A distinguishing feature of CCI INDIA's self-positioning is its identification as a dedicated State Investment Business Chamber, oriented specifically towards market entry, business expansion, and cross-border operational support for enterprises both Indian companies seeking to expand abroad and foreign and multinational companies seeking to establish or expand operations in India through joint ventures and market intelligence. This positions CCI INDIA less as a broad, sector-agnostic industry lobby and more as a specialised trade- and investment-facilitation body, a positioning directly relevant to the India–Georgia opportunity, where the binding constraint (as established in Chapter 3) is not diplomatic goodwill but the absence of a dedicated institutional bridge for market entry and business matchmaking.

How CCI INDIA Differs from CII, FICCI and ASSOCHAM

India's three largest apex chambers the Confederation of Indian Industry (CII), the Federation of Indian Chambers of Commerce and Industry (FICCI, established 1927), and the Associated Chambers of Commerce and Industry of India (ASSOCHAM) operate primarily as broad-based policy advocacy platforms, representing the collective voice of Indian industry across virtually all sectors and engaging in high-level government consultation, large-scale annual summits, and broad research publication.

Their scale and general-purpose mandate makes them natural first points of contact for major bilateral economic relationships (such as India's relationships with the United States, the European Union, or ASEAN), but also means that smaller, emerging bilateral relationships such as India–Georgia must compete for institutional attention and bandwidth against much larger and more established priorities.

CCI INDIA's comparatively focused, market-entry- and matchmaking-oriented mandate, and its explicit self-positioning as a dedicated investment facilitation chamber, make it structurally better suited to sustained, hands-on engagement with a frontier market of Georgia's scale than a general-purpose apex body would be. Where CII, FICCI or ASSOCHAM might engage with Georgia periodically as part of a broader Central Asia or Eastern Europe initiative, CCI INDIA can adopt India–Georgia economic cooperation as a flagship, sustained institutional priority precisely the kind of focused, long-horizon commitment that under-served bilateral relationships require to move from diplomatic goodwill to commercial substance.

Potential Role of CCI INDIA

CCI INDIA should explicitly position its Georgia initiative beginning with this Knowledge Paper as a flagship demonstration of its differentiated institutional value proposition: sustained, dedicated engagement with an emerging market that larger, general-purpose chambers are structurally less likely to prioritise.

4.2 Services

CCI INDIA's core service offering, and the manner in which each maps onto the India–Georgia opportunity identified in this report, is summarised below.

- **Trade Facilitation:** end-to-end support for Indian exporters and importers, including documentation, regulatory guidance, and market-entry advisory directly applicable to Indian MSMEs seeking to navigate Georgian customs, certification and phytosanitary requirements (Chapter 2.3).
- **Certificates of Origin:** issuance of Certificates of Origin required for preferential access under trade agreements directly relevant to Indian firms seeking to structure Georgia-based operations to access DCFTA or China-FTA preferences (Chapter 2.3).
- **Buyer–Seller Meets:** structured matchmaking events connecting Indian exporters with foreign buyers the primary near-term mechanism recommended in this report for connecting Indian agri-processing, pharmaceutical, and ICT exporters with Georgian counterparts (Chapter 5).
- **Trade Delegations:** organisation and coordination of outbound and inbound business delegations the recommended vehicle for the proposed India–Georgia Business Council's inaugural engagement (Chapter 7).
- **Investment Forums:** platforms convening investors, government officials and corporates to explore joint ventures and capital deployment applicable to renewable energy, logistics and agri-processing investment opportunities identified in Chapters 5 and 6.

- **Policy Advocacy:** representation of industry interests to government on regulatory, tariff and bilateral-agreement matters the mechanism through which CCI INDIA can press for revival of the India–Georgia FTA feasibility track and negotiation of a Bilateral Investment Treaty (Chapter 2.3, Chapter 3.3).
- **Alternative Dispute Resolution (ADR):** institutional facilities for resolving commercial disputes without recourse to litigation a valuable reassurance for Indian firms entering an unfamiliar Georgian legal and regulatory environment.
- **Legal Support:** guidance on cross-border regulatory, contractual and compliance matters relevant to Indian investors evaluating Georgia's foreign-ownership and repatriation rules (Chapter 2.2).
- **MSME Assistance:** dedicated support for small and medium enterprises seeking to internationalise central to this report's emphasis on Georgia as a comparatively low-cost, low-risk entry point for Indian MSME exporters (Executive Summary).
- **Capacity Building:** training, workshops and seminars equipping Indian businesses with market-specific knowledge the recommended format for CCI INDIA's proposed Georgia Market Monitor and market-entry guidance publications (Chapter 2.1, Chapter 2.3).

Potential Role of CCI INDIA

CCI INDIA should package its existing service portfolio into a dedicated 'Georgia Desk' a single point of institutional accountability bundling trade facilitation, Certificate of Origin issuance, Buyer–Seller Meet coordination, and MSME advisory specifically for the Georgian and wider South Caucasus market, avoiding the fragmentation that can occur when a new-market initiative is spread thinly across a chamber's general service lines.

4.3 Sectoral Alignment

Drawing on the sectoral analysis in Chapters 2, 5 and 6, the following table maps CCI INDIA's core sectoral constituencies to the corresponding Georgian opportunity, providing a practical basis for CCI INDIA to prioritise outreach to specific member segments.

Table 4.1: CCI INDIA Sectoral Alignment with Georgian Opportunity

CCI INDIA Sector Constituency	Georgia Opportunity
Agriculture & Food Processing	Wine, hazelnuts, organic foods, mineral water imports; joint agri-processing ventures
Healthcare & Pharmaceuticals	Generic pharmaceutical exports; medical education partnerships (Georgia's resident Indian student base)
Renewable Energy	Hydropower, solar and green hydrogen equipment exports and EPC/investment opportunities

CCI INDIA Sector Constituency	Georgia Opportunity
Logistics & Transport	Middle Corridor transit route diversification; port and rail services cooperation
Information & Communication Technology	Software exports, cybersecurity cooperation, near-shoring partnerships with Georgia's Virtual Zone regime
MSMEs	Low-cost, low-risk market entry via Buyer–Seller Meets and trade facilitation support
Tourism & Hospitality	Two-way tourism promotion; hospitality investment partnerships
Machinery & Electrical Equipment	Established Indian export category to Georgia; scope for expansion via FTA-preferential re-export
Financial Services	Correspondent banking and remittance services for Georgia's resident Indian community

4.4 Government Linkages

CCI INDIA's effectiveness as an India–Georgia trade facilitator will depend substantially on its ability to mobilise the instruments and mandates of India's principal trade and investment promotion bodies. The following linkages are of particular relevance:

- Ministry of Commerce and Industry: the apex policy authority for India's trade agreements, export promotion strategy, and bilateral economic relationships; the natural government counterpart for reviving the dormant India–Georgia FTA feasibility track (Chapter 2.3) and for according institutional recognition to a proposed India–Georgia Business Council.
- Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT): administers India's Foreign Trade Policy, export incentive schemes, and trade documentation requirements; relevant to CCI INDIA's proposed bilateral Trade Information Desk (Chapter 3.2).
- Invest India: the national investment promotion and facilitation agency; a natural co-convenor for outbound Indian investment missions to Georgia and inbound Georgian investment promotion in India (Chapter 3.3, Chapter 7.3).
- Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority (APEDA): supports export promotion for agricultural and processed food products; directly relevant to Indian agri-exports and joint ventures in Georgian wine, hazelnut and organic food value chains (Chapter 5.1).
- Export-Import Bank of India (EXIM Bank): provides Lines of Credit, project and trade finance for Indian exporters and investors; a key instrument for financing Indian

participation in Georgian infrastructure, agri-processing and renewable energy projects (Chapter 7.4).

- Export Credit Guarantee Corporation (ECGC): provides export credit insurance, de-risking Indian exporters' entry into the still-unfamiliar Georgian market (Chapter 7.4).
- National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development (NABARD): supports agricultural and rural development financing, relevant to potential cooperative or contract-farming arrangements linked to Georgian agri-value chains.
- Ministry of MSME: administers schemes supporting MSME internationalisation, aligning with CCI INDIA's MSME-focused service offering (Section 4.2) and this report's emphasis on Georgia as an MSME-accessible market.
- Pharmaceuticals Export Promotion Council (Pharmexcil): the sectoral export promotion body for Indian pharmaceutical exporters, directly relevant to expanding India's largest existing export category to Georgia (Chapter 3.2).
- Other sectoral Export Promotion Councils (Engineering Export Promotion Council, Electronics and Computer Software Export Promotion Council, and others): relevant to machinery, electrical equipment and ICT export promotion respectively.

Implications for CCI INDIA

CCI INDIA's institutional value in the India–Georgia relationship lies not in duplicating the mandates of these government bodies, but in acting as the connective and coordinating institution that brings their instruments to bear on a market that, to date, none of them has treated as a standing priority. A formal Memorandum of Understanding or working arrangement between CCI INDIA and each of the above bodies, specifically referencing Georgia and the wider South Caucasus, would give this report's recommendations institutional traction beyond the chamber's own resources.

Chapter 5 Sector-wise Trade Analysis

This chapter examines nine sectors of the Georgian economy in greater commercial detail, assessing current status, trade performance, India's present engagement, and near-term opportunities and challenges for Indian exporters and investors.

5.1 Agriculture & Food Processing

Current Status

Agriculture remains a structurally important, employment-intensive sector of the Georgian economy, anchored by wine, hazelnuts, citrus, and mineral water, with a growing organic and specialty-food segment targeting EU and East Asian markets.

Trade Performance & Major Partners

Georgian wine exports reached roughly 89.7 million litres across 71 countries in 2025 (average price USD 2.98/litre); hazelnuts remain a top-five global production category; overall agri-exports grew 15% year-on-year in Q1 2026. Major trading partners: Russia, CIS states, EU (Germany, Poland), China, and increasingly the Gulf and East Asia.

India's Present Role

India's role is presently limited to modest imports of Georgian wine and hazelnuts through specialty importers, and negligible Indian agri-exports to Georgia beyond limited cereals.

Opportunities

- Joint ventures in hazelnut and wine processing, packaging, and branding for the Indian premium consumer market
- Indian food-processing machinery and cold-chain equipment exports to Georgia's expanding agro-processing sector
- Organic certification cooperation, leveraging India's own organic-farming export experience via APEDA

Challenges

- Limited direct shipping and logistics links raising transport costs
- Low mutual brand awareness in each other's consumer markets
- Divergent food safety and certification standards requiring harmonisation

Potential Role of CCI INDIA

CCI INDIA can organise a dedicated Agri-Processing Buyer–Seller Meet pairing Indian importers of wine, hazelnuts and mineral water with Georgian producers, and support Indian machinery exporters seeking to supply Georgia's agro-processing sector.

5.2 Pharmaceuticals

Current Status

Georgia's pharmaceutical market remains dominated by imported drugs, with only a small share produced domestically; consumer demand is shifting towards generics amid government cost-containment efforts and rising healthcare expenditure.

Trade Performance & Major Partners

Georgia's imports of medicinal and pharmaceutical products reached approximately USD 114.4 million in December 2024 alone (up from USD 87.9 million in December 2023), with packaged medicaments among Georgia's top five import categories by value. Major trading partners: Turkey, Germany, the EU, and increasingly generics suppliers from Asia.

India's Present Role

Pharmaceuticals are already India's single largest export category to Georgia (part of the USD 242 million total, 2024); India's status as the 'Pharmacy of the World', supplying roughly one-fifth of global generic medicine volumes, positions it strongly to expand this share further.

Opportunities

- Expanded generic drug registration and market entry, building on Georgia's policy preference for generics
- Potential local formulation or packaging partnerships to serve both the Georgian market and re-export under DCFTA preferences
- Cooperation on pharmaceutical regulatory harmonisation to speed market authorisation for Indian formulations

Challenges

- Georgian regulatory registration timelines and documentation requirements
- Competition from well-established Turkish and European suppliers
- Limited direct visibility of Indian generics brands among Georgian prescribers and pharmacists

Potential Role of CCI INDIA

CCI INDIA can work with Pharmexcil to organise a Georgia-focused pharmaceutical registration and market-access workshop for Indian generics manufacturers, and support delegations to meet Georgia's Ministry of Health and major pharmacy chains.

5.3 ICT & Digital Services

Current Status

Georgia's ICT sector is its fastest-growing services export category, underpinned by a 0%-tax Virtual Zone regime for foreign-sourced IT income, growing technical talent, and rising near-shoring interest from EU and US clients.

Trade Performance & Major Partners

ICT service exports reached USD 842 million in 2024 and rose 52.3% year-on-year to USD 898 million in Q3 2025, now representing roughly 14% of total Georgian service exports. Major trading partners: European Union, United States, and neighbouring CIS markets.

India's Present Role

Indian IT/ITeS engagement with Georgia remains minimal to date, despite India's global leadership in outsourced software development, cybersecurity services, and enterprise IT.

Opportunities

- Enterprise software, cybersecurity, and fintech solution exports to Georgia's growing digital economy
- Potential Georgia-based near-shore delivery partnerships for Indian IT firms targeting EU clients under the Virtual Zone tax regime
- Cooperation between India's NASSCOM and Georgia's Innovation and Technology Agency (GITA) on skilling and startup exchange

Challenges

- Small absolute market size limiting near-term revenue scale
- Limited brand recognition of Indian IT firms in the Georgian and wider South Caucasus enterprise market
- Competition from established EU and Israeli technology partners

Potential Role of CCI INDIA

CCI INDIA can facilitate an India–Georgia Digital Economy Dialogue, connecting NASSCOM and Indian cybersecurity firms with GITA and Georgian technology parks, and can explore a Startup Exchange programme alongside Invest India's Startup India initiative.

5.4 Renewable Energy

Current Status

Georgia's electricity generation is hydropower-dominant (installed capacity of roughly 4.5 GW, of which hydropower accounts for over 3.3 GW), with growing but still nascent solar and wind development, and an emerging interest in green hydrogen.

Trade Performance & Major Partners

Georgia auctioned renewable capacity of up to 1,500 MW over three years under a new Contract-for-Differences support mechanism, and launched its Georgian Energy Exchange (GENEX) in July 2024 to liberalise electricity trading; a pilot green-hydrogen project (Batumi, EU/KfW-supported) began in 2024. Major trading partners: Czech (Energo-Pro), Georgian Industrial Group, Turkish and European developers dominate current generation and trading.

India's Present Role

Indian renewable energy engineering, equipment supply, and EPC firms have no significant established presence in Georgia to date, despite deep Indian expertise in hydropower engineering, solar EPC, and, increasingly, green hydrogen electrolyser manufacturing.

Opportunities

- Participation by Indian EPC and equipment firms in Georgia's CfD-backed renewable auctions
- Cooperation via the International Solar Alliance and India's National Green Hydrogen Mission on technology transfer and joint pilot projects
- Small hydropower and micro-hydro equipment exports, leveraging India's own small-hydro manufacturing base

Challenges

- Georgia's historical difficulties in environmental impact assessment and public acceptance for hydropower projects
- Absence of long-term Indian corporate presence or track record in the Georgian energy sector
- Competition from established European and Gulf-backed energy investors

Potential Role of CCI INDIA

CCI INDIA can coordinate with the Ministry of New and Renewable Energy and the International Solar Alliance to explore Indian participation in Georgia's renewable energy auctions, and can support Indian green-hydrogen technology providers in engaging Georgia's KfW-backed pilot programme.

5.5 Logistics & Transport

Current Status

Georgia's logistics sector is being reshaped by Middle Corridor cargo growth, ongoing Anaklia port construction, and rail/road infrastructure upgrades discussed in Chapter 2.4.

Trade Performance & Major Partners

Middle Corridor cargo volumes have grown substantially since 2022 as Northern Corridor (Russia-transit) volumes have declined; precise, verified 2025-26 Georgia-specific freight tonnages vary by source and should be confirmed directly with Georgian Railway and port operators. Major trading partners: Azerbaijan, Kazakhstan, Türkiye, China, and the European Union.

India's Present Role

Indian participation in Middle Corridor logistics planning and investment remains negligible; India's own INSTC-focused connectivity strategy has not yet been systematically linked to Georgia's Middle Corridor role.

Opportunities

- Indian logistics operator participation in Middle Corridor freight-forwarding and multimodal services
- Potential Indian investment interest in Anaklia port ancillary services once construction milestones are confirmed
- Linkage of INSTC and Middle Corridor route-planning for Indian cargo bound for the Black Sea and Europe

Challenges

- Continued uncertainty over Anaklia port completion timelines
- Complex multi-jurisdictional customs and documentation requirements across the corridor
- Limited existing Indian commercial relationships with Georgian, Azerbaijani and Kazakh logistics operators

Potential Role of CCI INDIA

CCI INDIA can convene Indian logistics and freight-forwarding companies to assess Middle Corridor route economics, and represent Indian industry views in Trans-Caspian Transport Corridor Coordination Platform engagements where possible.

5.6 Machinery & Electrical Equipment

Current Status

Machinery and electrical equipment together already constitute a meaningful share of India's existing exports to Georgia, reflecting Georgia's ongoing infrastructure and construction investment.

Trade Performance & Major Partners

Machinery and electrical equipment rank among the top categories within India's approximately USD 242 million in exports to Georgia (2024); Georgia's own imports of machinery remain dominated by European, Turkish and Chinese suppliers. Major trading partners: Germany, Turkey, China, and other European suppliers.

India's Present Role

India already has an established, if modest, export base in this category and a recognised competitive strength in mid-range industrial and electrical equipment manufacturing.

Opportunities

- Expansion of existing Indian machinery exports, leveraging price competitiveness against European suppliers
- Potential re-export of Georgia-assembled Indian machinery components into DCFTA and China-FTA markets
- Participation in Georgia's infrastructure and renewable energy construction pipeline as an equipment supplier

Challenges

- Established European and Turkish supplier relationships and after-sales service networks
- Limited Indian brand presence in Georgian industrial and construction procurement
- Technical standards alignment (EU CE marking and related certifications) required for competitiveness

Potential Role of CCI INDIA

CCI INDIA can support Indian engineering and electrical equipment exporters in obtaining relevant EU-aligned certifications and can organise sector-specific trade delegations timed with major Georgian infrastructure tenders.

5.7 Tourism

Current Status

Tourism is one of Georgia's largest foreign exchange earners, with wine tourism, mountain destinations, and Black Sea coastal resorts as principal draws, and rising interest from Gulf, East Asian and Indian travellers.

Trade Performance & Major Partners

Tourism revenue reached approximately USD 4.6 billion in 2025 (up 4.9% year-on-year), with growth projected to continue into 2026. Major trading partners: Russia, Turkey, EU states, Israel, and the Gulf states.

India's Present Role

India represents a small but rising source market for Georgian tourism, particularly leisure travel and destination weddings, aided by Georgia's visa-friendly policies and growing direct/one-stop air connectivity.

Opportunities

- Joint tourism promotion campaigns building on Georgia's participation in India's Incredible India tourism seminars
- Indian hospitality investment in boutique and wine-tourism accommodation
- Reciprocal promotion of India as a destination for Georgian tour operators and travellers

Challenges

- Limited direct flight connectivity between India and Georgia relative to demand potential
- Low awareness among Indian travel agents of Georgia as a destination beyond a small niche market
- Seasonal concentration of Georgian tourism demand

Potential Role of CCI INDIA

CCI INDIA can organise reciprocal tourism Buyer–Seller Meets connecting Indian travel agents and wedding planners with Georgian hospitality operators, coordinated with the Georgian National Tourism Administration.

5.8 Minerals & Metals

Current Status

Mining and metals form Georgia's largest goods export category by value, anchored in manganese (Chiatura), copper ore, and ferro-alloys, alongside a substantial car and gold re-export trade.

Trade Performance & Major Partners

Georgia's top 2024 exports included ferro-alloys (USD 330 million) and precious metal ore (USD 234 million); top imports included gold (USD 703 million), reflecting Georgia's role as a regional bullion and vehicle re-export hub as much as a primary metals producer. Major trading partners: Turkey, China, Russia, and CIS states.

India's Present Role

India's engagement to date has been limited, though the JSW Steel–Georgian Steel Group Holding scrap-to-rebar joint venture, discussed in Chapter 3.3, demonstrates commercial feasibility.

Opportunities

- Raw material sourcing partnerships for Indian steel and metals manufacturers
- Further joint-venture manufacturing following the JSW Steel precedent
- Potential Indian participation in Georgia's ferro-alloy and manganese value chain upgrading

Challenges

- Price competition from established Turkish and Chinese buyers
- Logistics costs for bulk mineral shipments absent direct shipping links
- Limited transparency in some legacy mining sector ownership structures

Potential Role of CCI INDIA

CCI INDIA can facilitate direct engagement between Indian steel and metals producers and Georgian mining companies, building on the JSW Steel joint-venture precedent as a reference case for prospective Indian investors.

5.9 Textiles

Current Status

Textiles are not currently a flagship sector for either Georgian exports or Georgia-bound Indian exports, but Georgia's DCFTA and China-FTA access, combined with relatively low labour costs, offer latent potential for textile and garment value-chain investment.

Trade Performance & Major Partners

Bilateral India–Georgia textile trade remains negligible in current UN Comtrade and ITC Trade Map data, representing a genuine greenfield opportunity rather than an established trade line. Major trading partners: EU, Turkey (for Georgian textile imports); India presently has no meaningful textile trade with Georgia.

India's Present Role

India is among the world's largest textile and garment exporters, but has not yet explored Georgia as either an export market or an assembly/re-export base for EU market access.

Opportunities

- Feasibility assessment of Georgia-based garment assembly for DCFTA-preferential access to the EU market
- Indian textile machinery exports to any emerging Georgian garment manufacturing capacity
- Direct Indian textile and apparel exports to Georgia's growing retail and tourism-linked consumer market

Challenges

- No established Georgian garment manufacturing base to partner with at present
- Absence of existing trade relationships or market data to build upon
- Competition from lower-cost EU-proximate manufacturing locations (e.g., Türkiye, North Africa) for EU-bound assembly

Potential Role of CCI INDIA

CCI INDIA can commission a feasibility study, in partnership with India's Apparel Export Promotion Council, on Georgia-based garment assembly for DCFTA-preferential EU market access, given the current absence of established competitors in this specific niche.

Chapter 6 High-Potential Sub-Vertical Analysis

Building on the sector-wide analysis in Chapter 5, this chapter drills into nine specific sub-verticals across agriculture, ICT, and renewable energy the three sectors identified throughout this report as offering the strongest near-term India–Georgia complementarity to identify the most implementation-ready opportunities.

6.1 Agriculture Sub-Verticals

Hazelnuts

Georgia is among the world's top five hazelnut-producing countries, with the EU (Italy, Spain, Germany, France, Greece) as the dominant export market.

Market Trends: Global hazelnut demand continues to grow, driven by confectionery and spreads manufacturing, with buyers increasingly seeking to diversify supply beyond Turkey, the dominant global producer.

Challenges: Crop yield volatility due to disease (notably brown marmorated stink bug damage in past seasons) and fragmented smallholder production.

Opportunities: Indian confectionery, chocolate and packaged food manufacturers could source Georgian hazelnuts directly, diversifying supply away from Turkish dependence; potential joint processing investment in shelling and grading facilities.

India's Competitive Strength: India's large and growing packaged food and confectionery manufacturing sector provides ready end-demand, though India is not itself a hazelnut producer, eliminating competitive conflict.

Potential Role of CCI INDIA

CCI INDIA can connect Indian confectionery and food manufacturers' associations directly with Georgian hazelnut exporter cooperatives to establish direct sourcing relationships.

Wine

Georgia, with over 8,000 years of continuous winemaking history and UNESCO recognition of its traditional qvevri winemaking method, exported approximately 89.7 million litres of wine to 71 countries in 2025.

Market Trends: Premium-market export prices (USD 5–6+/litre in the US, Japan and UK) substantially exceed traditional CIS market prices (closer to USD 2/litre), incentivising diversification towards premium markets.

Challenges: Limited brand recognition in Asian markets including India; import duty and distribution complexities in the Indian alcoholic beverage market, which is regulated at the state level.

Opportunities: Introduction of Georgian qvevri wine to India's growing premium wine consumer segment in metropolitan markets; potential for Georgian wine tourism packages bundled with Indian outbound travel.

India's Competitive Strength: India's rapidly growing premium and imported alcoholic beverage market provides a natural, if regulatorily complex, new demand market for Georgian wine exporters seeking diversification.

Potential Role of CCI INDIA

CCI INDIA can facilitate introductions between Georgia's National Wine Agency and India's premium wine importers and hospitality chains, and support Georgian wine promotion at Indian trade fairs.

Organic Foods

Georgia's organic agriculture sector remains at an early stage of development but is expanding, supported by government diversification policy and EU market demand for certified organic products.

Market Trends: EU organic food demand continues to grow strongly, and Georgia's diversification drive has raised the combined EU/Middle East/East Asia share of Georgian agri-exports above 45%.

Challenges: Limited domestic organic certification infrastructure and a nascent farmer training ecosystem for organic transition.

Opportunities: Indian organic certification bodies and agricultural extension expertise (India has one of the world's largest organic-certified farmer bases) could support Georgian organic transition programmes; potential Indian import of Georgian organic specialty products.

India's Competitive Strength: India's APEDA has extensive experience developing organic certification and export infrastructure, directly transferable to Georgian capacity-building needs.

Potential Role of CCI INDIA

CCI INDIA can propose an APEDA-Georgia organic agriculture capacity-building partnership, positioning India as a technical partner rather than solely a trading counterpart.

6.2 ICT Sub-Verticals

Software Outsourcing & Global Business Services

Georgia's Virtual Zone tax regime and growing technical talent pool have begun attracting near-shore software development interest, primarily from EU clients.

Market Trends: Nearshoring demand from EU clients seeking alternatives to distant offshore delivery centres continues to grow, benefiting Georgia's time-zone proximity to Europe.

Challenges: Small scale of Georgia's existing tech talent pool relative to established outsourcing hubs; limited brand recognition of Georgia as a delivery location among global enterprise buyers.

Opportunities: Indian IT majors could establish small Georgia-based delivery or client-liaison operations to serve EU clients under Virtual Zone tax benefits, complementing rather than replacing India-based delivery.

India's Competitive Strength: India remains the world's largest software services exporter, with the scale, process maturity, and quality-certification experience to mentor or partner with Georgia's smaller, emerging technology sector.

Potential Role of CCI INDIA

CCI INDIA can facilitate a NASSCOM-GITA Memorandum of Understanding exploring complementary delivery partnerships and skilling exchange.

Cybersecurity

Georgia has faced significant state-sponsored cyberattacks in recent years, driving government and private-sector investment in cybersecurity capacity.

Market Trends: Regional geopolitical tension continues to elevate demand for cybersecurity infrastructure, monitoring, and incident-response capability across the South Caucasus.

Challenges: Limited existing commercial relationships between Indian cybersecurity firms and Georgian public or private-sector buyers.

Opportunities: Export of Indian cybersecurity software, managed security services, and training programmes to Georgian government and financial-sector clients.

India's Competitive Strength: India has a rapidly growing cybersecurity industry and increasing experience in critical-infrastructure protection, relevant to Georgia's stated priorities.

Potential Role of CCI INDIA

CCI INDIA can support Indian cybersecurity firms in engaging Georgia's Data Exchange Agency and financial sector regulators to explore market entry.

FinTech

Georgia's banking sector is sound and increasingly digitised, with growing interest in digital payments, remittance technology, and financial inclusion tools.

Market Trends: Regional demand for efficient remittance and cross-border payment solutions is rising, relevant given the scale of Georgia's own diaspora remittance inflows and its resident international student population, including Indian students.

Challenges: Regulatory licensing requirements for financial technology providers and limited existing Indian fintech commercial presence in the Caucasus.

Opportunities: Indian fintech and digital payment providers (drawing on India's globally recognised Unified Payments Interface model) could explore partnerships supporting remittance flows to and from Georgia's resident Indian student community, and broader Georgian financial digitisation.

India's Competitive Strength: India's National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) has actively pursued international UPI partnerships and represents a strong reference model for potential Georgian collaboration.

Potential Role of CCI INDIA

CCI INDIA can facilitate introductory dialogue between NPCI and the National Bank of Georgia on potential digital payments cooperation, framed around serving Georgia's resident Indian community as an initial use case.

6.3 Renewable Energy Sub-Verticals

Hydropower

Hydropower supplies the large majority of Georgia's domestic electricity generation, with substantial further technical potential (estimated at up to 15,000 MW) remaining undeveloped.

Market Trends: Seasonal generation volatility (surplus in spring/summer, deficits in winter) is driving interest in complementary storage and diversified renewable investment.

Challenges: Public opposition to large hydropower projects on environmental and community-impact grounds, and financing challenges for small and medium-scale projects.

Opportunities: Indian small- and micro-hydropower equipment manufacturers and engineering firms could supply Georgia's numerous licensed but under-financed small hydropower project pipeline.

India's Competitive Strength: India has one of the world's largest small-hydropower manufacturing and engineering sectors, developed to serve its own extensive domestic small-hydro programme.

Potential Role of CCI INDIA

CCI INDIA can connect Indian small-hydro equipment manufacturers with Georgia's Ministry of Economy and Sustainable Development to explore participation in the licensed small-hydro project pipeline.

Green Hydrogen

Georgia has launched an initial green-hydrogen pilot project in Batumi (with EU and German KfW support) applying hydrogen to public transport, motivated partly by the EU's Carbon Border Adjustment Mechanism taking full effect in 2026.

Market Trends: EU decarbonisation policy and CBAM compliance pressure are likely to sustain interest in green hydrogen and low-carbon industrial inputs across Georgia's EU-facing export sectors.

Challenges: Early-stage technology and infrastructure development, high initial capital costs, and limited existing Georgian regulatory framework for green hydrogen.

Opportunities: Cooperation opportunities for Indian electrolyser manufacturers and green-hydrogen project developers under India's National Green Hydrogen Mission, potentially as a technology and financing partner in scaling Georgia's pilot programmes.

India's Competitive Strength: India's National Green Hydrogen Mission has driven rapid growth in domestic electrolyser manufacturing capacity and cost reduction, positioning Indian firms as credible technology partners for emerging-market green hydrogen programmes.

Potential Role of CCI INDIA

CCI INDIA can facilitate engagement between India's National Green Hydrogen Mission secretariat and Georgia's Ministry of Environmental Protection and Agriculture to explore technology and pilot-project cooperation.

Chapter 7 Policy Recommendations and Financial Mechanisms

This chapter sets out implementation-ready recommendations across five domains: institutional cooperation, trade facilitation, investment promotion, financial mechanisms, and policy cooperation. Each recommendation follows a consistent structure to support direct translation into action by CCI INDIA, government stakeholders, and industry partners.

7.1 Institutional Cooperation

India–Georgia Business Council

Objective: Establish a dedicated institutional platform for private-sector engagement between India and Georgia.

Recommendation: CCI INDIA to formally establish and secretariat an India–Georgia Business Council, with Georgian Chamber of Commerce and Industry as counterpart.

Implementation: Launch event co-hosted with the Indian Embassy in Tbilisi; quarterly virtual and annual in-person meetings; founding membership drawn from CCI INDIA's agri-processing, pharmaceutical, ICT and renewable energy constituencies.

Key Stakeholders: CCI INDIA, Georgian Chamber of Commerce and Industry, Embassy of India (Tbilisi), Ministry of Commerce and Industry.

Expected Outcome: A standing, durable institutional bridge for bilateral business engagement, filling the gap identified in Chapter 3.5.

Annual Economic Dialogue

Objective: Provide a senior-level forum reviewing progress on bilateral economic cooperation annually.

Recommendation: Propose an annual India–Georgia Economic Dialogue, convened alongside the existing Inter-Governmental Commission mechanism.

Implementation: CCI INDIA to propose agenda items and prepare an annual progress report against this Knowledge Paper's recommendations, for submission to both governments.

Key Stakeholders: Ministry of Commerce and Industry, Ministry of Economy and Sustainable Development of Georgia, CCI INDIA.

Expected Outcome: Sustained ministerial-level attention and accountability for bilateral economic cooperation commitments.

Sector Working Groups

Objective: Translate sectoral opportunities identified in Chapters 5 and 6 into structured, ongoing collaboration.

Recommendation: Establish working groups for agri-processing, pharmaceuticals, ICT, and renewable energy under the India–Georgia Business Council.

Implementation: Each working group co-chaired by an Indian and Georgian industry representative, meeting quarterly, with CCI INDIA providing secretariat support.

Key Stakeholders: CCI INDIA, sectoral Export Promotion Councils, Enterprise Georgia, GITA.

Expected Outcome: Structured, sector-specific momentum translating broad opportunity identification into concrete transactions.

Institutional MoUs

Objective: Formalise CCI INDIA's working relationships with relevant Indian and Georgian government bodies.

Recommendation: Negotiate Memoranda of Understanding between CCI INDIA and each of Invest India, APEDA, Pharmexcil, and Enterprise Georgia, specifically referencing Georgia/South Caucasus engagement.

Implementation: Sequential MoU negotiation over the short-term roadmap period (Chapter 8), beginning with Invest India and Enterprise Georgia.

Key Stakeholders: CCI INDIA, Invest India, APEDA, Pharmexcil, Enterprise Georgia.

Expected Outcome: Institutional traction and resource mobilisation beyond CCI INDIA's own capacity.

7.2 Trade Facilitation

Buyer–Seller Meets & Trade Missions

Objective: Generate direct commercial transactions between Indian and Georgian businesses in priority sectors.

Recommendation: Organise at least two Buyer–Seller Meets annually (agri-processing and pharmaceuticals in year one; ICT and renewable energy added in year two), alternating between India and Georgia.

Implementation: CCI INDIA to coordinate logistics, participant selection, and follow-up; Embassy of India to support visa facilitation and government introductions.

Key Stakeholders: CCI INDIA, Embassy of India (Tbilisi), Enterprise Georgia, sectoral Export Promotion Councils.

Expected Outcome: Measurable increase in bilateral trade transactions and participating-company counts year-on-year.

Digital Trade Portal & Market Intelligence

Objective: Reduce the information gap identified throughout this report as the central constraint on bilateral trade growth.

Recommendation: Develop a bilingual (English/Georgian) Digital Trade and Market Intelligence Portal profiling regulatory requirements, certification standards, and buyer/seller directories.

Implementation: CCI INDIA to commission portal development and maintain content jointly with DGFT trade data and Enterprise Georgia market information.

Key Stakeholders: CCI INDIA, DGFT, Enterprise Georgia, Invest India.

Expected Outcome: Reduced transaction costs and information asymmetry for Indian MSME exporters.

Trade Information Desk

Objective: Provide a single point of contact for Indian exporters with specific queries on the Georgian market.

Recommendation: Establish a dedicated Georgia Trade Information Desk within CCI INDIA, staffed to handle exporter queries on customs, certification, and logistics.

Implementation: Integrate with the proposed 'Georgia Desk' described in Chapter 4.2; publish quarterly bilateral trade data updates.

Key Stakeholders: CCI INDIA, DGFT.

Expected Outcome: Improved exporter responsiveness and reduced time-to-market-entry for Indian MSMEs.

7.3 Investment Promotion

Investment Forums & Roadshows

Objective: Raise awareness among Indian institutional and corporate investors of Georgia's investment climate.

Recommendation: Co-host an annual India–Georgia Investment Forum, alternating between Mumbai/Delhi and Tbilisi, profiling renewable energy, logistics, agri-processing and ICT opportunities.

Implementation: CCI INDIA and Invest India to jointly convene, with Enterprise Georgia and the Georgian National Investment Agency as co-hosts.

Key Stakeholders: CCI INDIA, Invest India, Enterprise Georgia.

Expected Outcome: Increased Indian FDI commitments to Georgia, moving beyond the isolated precedents (JSW Steel, individual land investors) documented in Chapter 3.3.

Startup Exchange & Joint Ventures

Objective: Extend bilateral cooperation to early-stage innovation and venture ecosystems.

Recommendation: Establish a Startup Exchange programme linking Indian and Georgian technology incubators, and actively promote joint-venture models following the JSW Steel–Georgian Steel Group Holding precedent in other sectors.

Implementation: CCI INDIA to coordinate with Startup India and GITA; publish a joint-venture case-study series to guide prospective Indian investors.

Key Stakeholders: CCI INDIA, Invest India (Startup India), GITA.

Expected Outcome: A pipeline of new joint ventures and startup partnerships beyond the current narrow base of Indian investment in Georgia.

7.4 Financial Mechanisms

A range of Indian and international financial instruments can support the recommendations above. CCI INDIA's role is to make Indian exporters and investors aware of these instruments as they apply specifically to Georgia, and to advocate for their active deployment.

Table 7.1: Indian Financial Instruments Relevant to India–Georgia Cooperation

Institution / Scheme	What It Is	Role for CCI INDIA / Benefit for Georgia
EXIM Bank Lines of Credit	Concessional credit facility supporting Indian exports and overseas projects	CCI INDIA can propose a Georgia-specific Line of Credit for infrastructure or agri-processing equipment purchases
ECGC Credit Insurance	Export credit risk insurance for Indian exporters	De-risks first-time Indian exporter entry into the unfamiliar Georgian market
APEDA Support Schemes	Export promotion assistance for agricultural and processed food exporters	Supports Indian agri-exporters and joint ventures in Georgian wine/hazelnut value chains
Market Access Initiative (MAI)	Government funding for export promotion activities including market studies and trade fairs	Can co-fund CCI INDIA's Georgia-focused Buyer–Seller Meets and market research
RoDTEP	Remission of Duties and Taxes on Exported Products scheme, refunding embedded taxes on exports	Improves price competitiveness of Indian exports to Georgia across all sectors

Institution / Scheme	What It Is	Role for CCI INDIA / Benefit for Georgia
Transport and Marketing Assistance (TMA)	Assistance offsetting higher freight costs for agricultural exports to distant markets	Directly relevant given the logistics cost challenges noted in Chapter 5.1
Trade Infrastructure for Export Scheme (TIES)	Funding for export-related infrastructure (logistics, testing labs, cold chains)	Could support Indian cold-chain infrastructure investment linked to Georgia-bound agri-exports
SIDBI	Financing and support for MSME internationalisation	Aligns with CCI INDIA's MSME-focused service offering (Chapter 4.2) for Georgia-bound MSME exporters
NABARD	Agricultural and rural development financing	Potential support for contract-farming or cooperative linkages tied to Georgian agri-value chains
International Solar Alliance	India-headquartered international coalition promoting solar deployment	Channel for connecting Indian solar EPC firms to Georgia's CfD renewable auctions (Chapter 6.3)
National Green Hydrogen Mission	India's national programme supporting green hydrogen production and export	Basis for India-Georgia green hydrogen technology cooperation (Chapter 6.3)

Table 7.2: International Financial Institutions Active in Georgia

Institution	What It Is	Benefit for Georgia / Role for CCI INDIA
World Bank	Multilateral development lender providing budget and project financing	Co-financier of Georgian infrastructure (ports, energy); CCI INDIA can track World Bank-financed tenders for Indian contractor participation
Asian Development Bank (ADB)	Regional multilateral development bank active in Central Asia and the Caucasus	Potential co-financing partner for Middle Corridor and renewable energy projects relevant to Indian participation

Institution	What It Is	Benefit for Georgia / Role for CCI INDIA
International Finance Corporation (IFC)	World Bank Group's private-sector investment arm	Potential co-investor alongside Indian corporates in Georgian agri-processing or energy ventures
European Bank for Reconstruction and Development (EBRD)	Development bank financing private-sector and infrastructure projects across Georgia	Leading financier of Georgian energy and port infrastructure; a natural co-financing partner to track
Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank (AIIB)	Multilateral infrastructure development bank with India as a founding member and major shareholder	India's own AIIB membership gives Indian industry a distinctive channel to engage Georgian infrastructure financing

7.5 Policy Cooperation

Beyond trade facilitation and investment promotion, several deeper policy-level reforms would materially improve the ease of India–Georgia commercial engagement. These include: reviving customs cooperation and mutual recognition arrangements to streamline certificate-of-origin and product-standard verification; deepening Sanitary and Phytosanitary (SPS) measures cooperation to accelerate Indian agricultural product access to the Georgian market; exploring a Digital Trade cooperation framework covering e-commerce and digital payments (linked to the fintech opportunities in Chapter 6.2); negotiating a Bilateral Investment Treaty and Double Taxation Avoidance Agreement to de-risk investment flows (Chapter 3.3); and expanding cooperation on Skills, Research, and the Startup Ecosystem, building on existing exchanges such as the Sushma Swaraj Institute's diplomat training programme and the Kendriya Hindi Sansthan's scholarship scheme (Chapter 3.5).

Potential Role of CCI INDIA

CCI INDIA should compile these policy-cooperation proposals into a single formal representation to the Ministry of Commerce and Industry, timed to coincide with the next round of India–Georgia Foreign Office Consultations or the Inter-Governmental Commission, ensuring that private-sector priorities are reflected in the government-to-government dialogue agenda.

Chapter 8 Strategic Roadmap

This chapter consolidates the report's recommendations into a phased roadmap across short-term, medium-term and long-term horizons, with parallel tracks for institutional, government, private-sector, and CCI INDIA-specific action.

8.1 Short-Term (1–2 Years)

- Establish the India–Georgia Business Council under CCI INDIA's stewardship, launched jointly with the Embassy of India, Tbilisi (Chapter 7.1).
- Set up the Georgia Trade Information Desk and begin publishing the Georgia Market Monitor briefing series (Chapters 2.1, 4.2, 7.2).
- Organise the first Buyer–Seller Meets in agri-processing and pharmaceuticals (Chapter 7.2).
- Initiate MoU negotiations between CCI INDIA and Invest India, APEDA, Pharmexcil, and Enterprise Georgia (Chapter 7.1).
- Formally petition the Ministry of Commerce and Industry to revive the dormant 2019 India-Georgia FTA feasibility track (Chapter 2.3).

8.2 Medium-Term (3–5 Years)

- Expand Sector Working Groups to cover ICT and renewable energy, alongside agri-processing and pharmaceuticals (Chapter 7.1).
- Launch the annual India–Georgia Investment Forum and Startup Exchange programme (Chapter 7.3).
- Support Indian participation in Georgia's renewable energy CfD auctions and green hydrogen pilot programmes, in coordination with the International Solar Alliance and National Green Hydrogen Mission (Chapter 6.3).
- Advocate for conclusion of a Bilateral Investment Treaty and Double Taxation Avoidance Agreement (Chapter 7.5).
- Assess the commercial viability of Middle Corridor routing for Indian cargo once Anaklia port construction milestones clarify (Chapter 2.4, Chapter 5.5).

8.3 Long-Term (5–10 Years)

- Pursue full negotiation of an India–Georgia Free Trade Agreement or Preferential Trade Agreement, building on the 2019 feasibility study (Chapter 2.3).
- Establish sustained Indian corporate presence in Georgia's agri-processing, pharmaceuticals, ICT, and renewable energy sectors, moving beyond the current narrow base of isolated investments (Chapter 3.3).
- Position Georgia as an established, active node in India's diversified Eurasian connectivity strategy, alongside the International North–South Transport Corridor (Chapter 1.3).
- Achieve a multi-fold increase in bilateral trade turnover from the current base of approximately USD 250–270 million combined, commensurate with the two countries' demonstrated economic complementarities.

Table 8.1: Roadmap Summary by Stakeholder Track

Track	Short-Term (1–2 yrs)	Medium-Term (3–5 yrs)	Long-Term (5–10 yrs)
CCI INDIA	Business Council; Trade Desk; first Buyer-Seller Meets	Sector Working Groups; Investment Forum	Institutionalised bilateral chamber-to-chamber relationship
Government (India)	Revive FTA feasibility track	Negotiate BIT/DTAA	Conclude FTA/PTA
Private Sector	Early exploratory trade transactions	Joint ventures; renewable energy auction participation	Established corporate presence across priority sectors

Conclusion

Georgia matters to India not because of the size of its domestic market, but because of what it represents strategically: a stable, reform-oriented, and rapidly growing economy sitting astride the Middle Corridor, with preferential access to the European Union, China, and a dozen other major markets, and a resident Indian community of tens of thousands of students and professionals that few Indian policymakers or businesses currently recognise as an asset. India, in turn, matters to Georgia as a market of 1.45 billion consumers, a global leader in generic pharmaceuticals, information technology, and renewable energy, and a rising diplomatic partner that has now, for the first time in over three decades of relations, established a resident ambassador in Tbilisi.

The strategic value of the India–Georgia partnership lies precisely in the gap this report has documented throughout: strong and improving diplomatic relations, a large and growing people-to-people bridge through education and, increasingly, tourism, and clear sectoral complementarities in agriculture, pharmaceuticals, ICT and renewable energy set against bilateral trade and investment flows that remain a fraction of what these foundations would justify. Closing this gap does not require new diplomatic breakthroughs; it requires sustained institutional effort to convert existing goodwill into commercial transactions, one Buyer–Seller Meet, one joint venture, and one trade mission at a time.

CCI INDIA is well positioned to lead this effort. Its differentiated mandate as a dedicated market-entry and investment-facilitation chamber, its existing service portfolio spanning trade facilitation, Certificates of Origin, Buyer–Seller Meets and MSME assistance, and its established linkages to India's principal trade and investment promotion bodies together give it the institutional tools required to establish the first dedicated India–Georgia business platform: the proposed India–Georgia Business Council.

Looking ahead, the success of this initiative should be measured not only in the growth of bilateral trade and investment figures, but in the durability of the institutional architecture it leaves behind: a standing Business Council, active Sector Working Groups, a functioning Digital Trade Portal, and, in time, a concluded Free Trade Agreement building on the dormant 2019 feasibility study. If realised, this agenda would allow CCI INDIA to demonstrate, through the concrete example of Georgia, the distinctive institutional value it can bring to India's engagement with emerging markets across the wider Eurasian space.

Strengthening Ties, Shaping Tomorrow

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